V A N T A G E & V E R I T Y

Deal Origination Brief · Lower Middle Market

How fundless sponsors and search fund operators go from zero proprietary deal flow to 6–12 qualified owner conversations in 90 days — without brokers, without auctions, and without adding a single headcount.

Using a mandate-driven origination system that reaches private business owners in the $2M–$15M EBITDA range before they've considered a sale, engaged an intermediary, or spoken with a competitor.

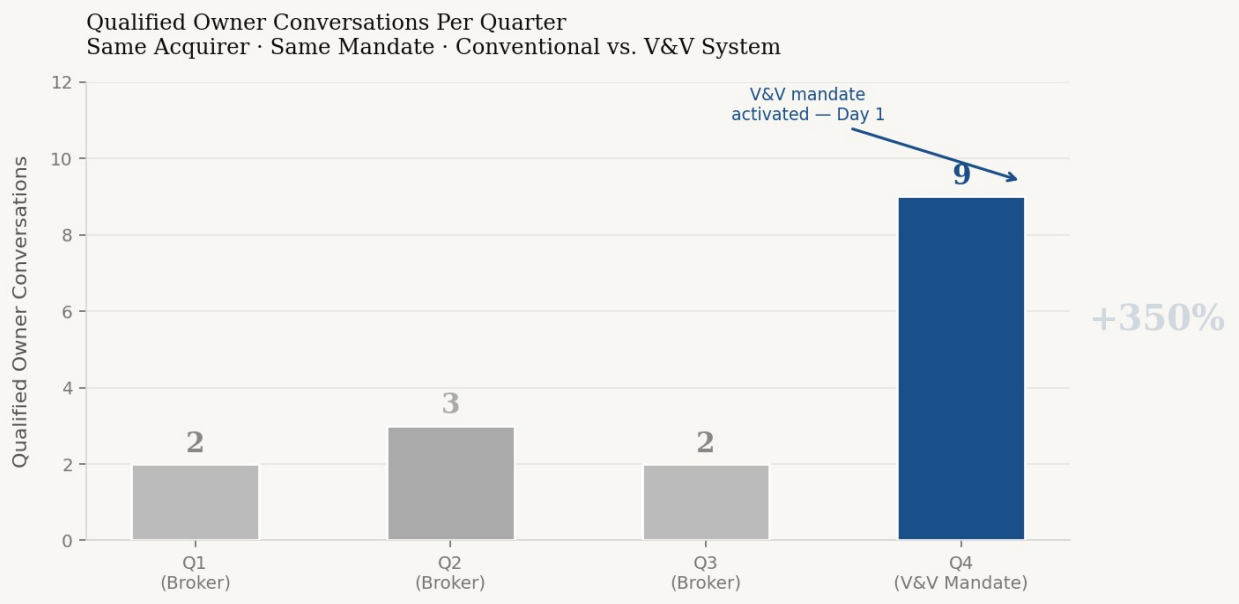


Fig. 1 · Same acquirer. Same mandate. Same target geography. Q1–Q3 using conventional broker-dependent origination. Q4 after a V&V mandate was activated.

A 2 — PROOF BEFORE WE GO FURTHER

Before the pitch: here are the results.

The following are representative engagements. Client identities are confidential per standard advisory practice. All outcomes are documented and available for reference in the mandate evaluation conversation.

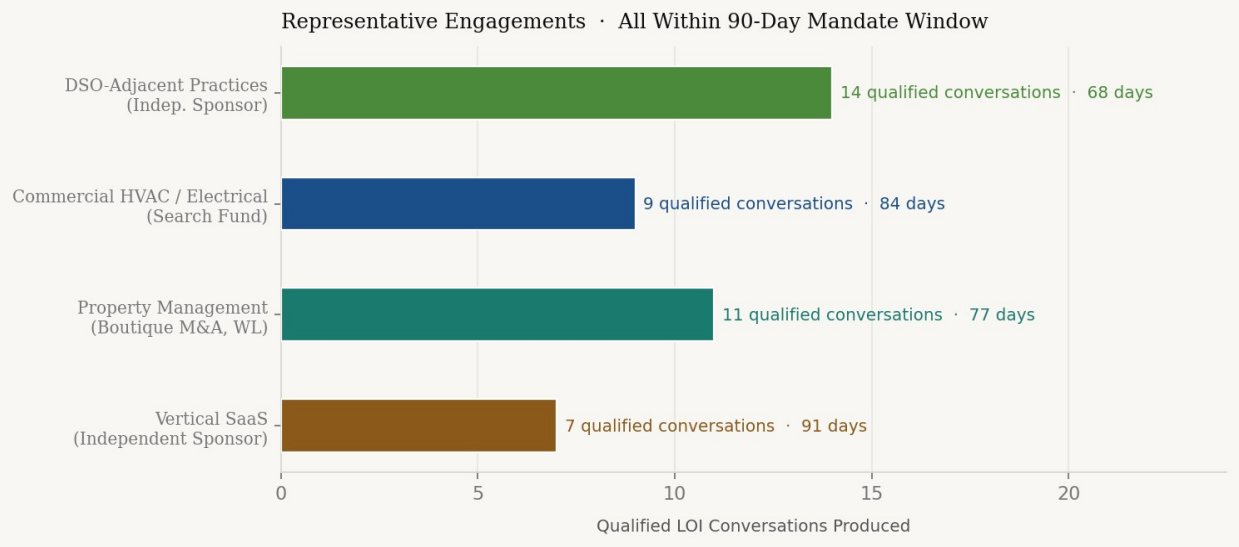


Fig. 2 · Qualified LOI conversations produced per engagement. All four mandates completed within the 90-day window. Zero brokered inventory in any pipeline.

Client Type	Before	After	Timeframe	How
Independent Sponsor — DSO Healthcare	0 off-market conversations in 6 months	14 qualified conversations	68 days	Owner-direct outreach, Sunbelt markets
Search Fund — Commercial Contractors	100% dependent on broker teasers	9 qualified conversations	84 days	1,400-owner verified list, Mountain West
Boutique M&A — Property Management	No systematic origination	11 qualified introductions	77 days	Succession narrative, white-label
Independent Sponsor — Vertical SaaS	No access to bootstrapped founders	7 qualified conversations	91 days	Steward-positioning, direct founder outreach

In every case, the client's prior approach — broker relationships, deal flow platforms, conference attendance — produced fewer qualified conversations over the preceding 6–12 months than the engagement produced in 90 days.

A 3 — WHO THIS IS FOR

Read this carefully. This is written for a specific person.

Before we go any further, confirm you are in the right place. The following is a description of the operator this system was built for.

What you want:

- Proprietary deal flow — not brokered inventory that 40 other firms received simultaneously.
- A pipeline you control that does not depend on intermediaries whose interests are structurally misaligned with yours.
- To reach owners before a process exists, before pricing has been anchored by a competitive dynamic, before your competitors know the business is a target.
- To close at multiples that make sense. Not auction multiples. The pricing advantage that comes from being first.

What you are afraid of:

- Another year of reviewing 200 teasers, submitting 40 LOIs, and closing nothing that fits your thesis at a price that works.
- Running out of runway before finding the right deal. If you are a search fund operator, the clock is visible. If you are an independent sponsor, the pressure from capital partners is real.
- Being consistently outcompeted by firms who seem to arrive at the right owner first — and you have no idea how they are doing it.

What has failed you:

- Broker relationships. You have invested time cultivating intermediaries who, when a deal comes in, send it to 20 firms simultaneously. The relationship does not translate into preferential access.

- Deal flow platforms. The businesses on those platforms are either overpriced, already in process, or not businesses you would want at any price.
- Conferences and networking. Real but slow and unpredictable. One or two leads per year. Not a system.

What you know to be true:

- The best deals in this market are never on a platform. The owners worth approaching have never spoken to a broker and would respond poorly to being contacted by one.
- The firm that reaches the owner first controls the conversation. You have seen it happen to a deal you wanted: you found out about it when it was already in process. You know what that feels like.
- Information asymmetry that creates pricing advantage exists only in the off-market, and the off-market is only accessible through direct, intelligent, well-timed outreach.

A 3 B — WHO THIS IS NOT FOR

This section exists to save everyone time.

- You are not a fit if you do not have a defined acquisition thesis. Our targeting requires precise parameters. “Good businesses at good prices” is not a mandate.
- You are not a fit if you need deal flow immediately. The system produces qualified conversations within 90 days — not two weeks.
- You are not a fit if you cannot move when a conversation appears. Our job ends at the introduction. If your evaluation process takes six months, the conversations go cold.
- You are not a fit if you believe all deals of consequence pass through brokers. We are not going to change your mind here. Go use a broker.

A 4 — CORE CONCEPT

Here is the truth.

You can go from zero proprietary deal flow to 6–12 qualified owner conversations in 90 days.

However, there is a reason most acquirers never build this: the infrastructure required — targeting, deliverability, owner-psychology narrative design, qualification — does not exist off the shelf and takes significant time and capital to build from scratch.

Deal origination is a marketing problem. Most acquirers treat it as a relationship problem.

The dominant playbook is reactive. By the time a deal enters the broker channel, the information asymmetry is gone. The business has been packaged. The seller has been coached. Multiple buyers have already received the teaser. Whatever pricing advantage once existed has been neutralized through a process specifically designed to neutralize it.

Being first is the only durable edge in this market. And being first, at scale, requires infrastructure that most acquirers have never built.

Fig. 3 · The structural difference between conventional origination and the V&V mandate system. The gap is not effort. It is infrastructure and timing.

> *“The broker’s job is to maximize seller proceeds in a competitive process. Your job is to avoid that process entirely. Those objectives are irreconcilable. You cannot win by playing the broker’s game better. You win by not playing it.”*

A5 — CREDIBILITY & BACKGROUND

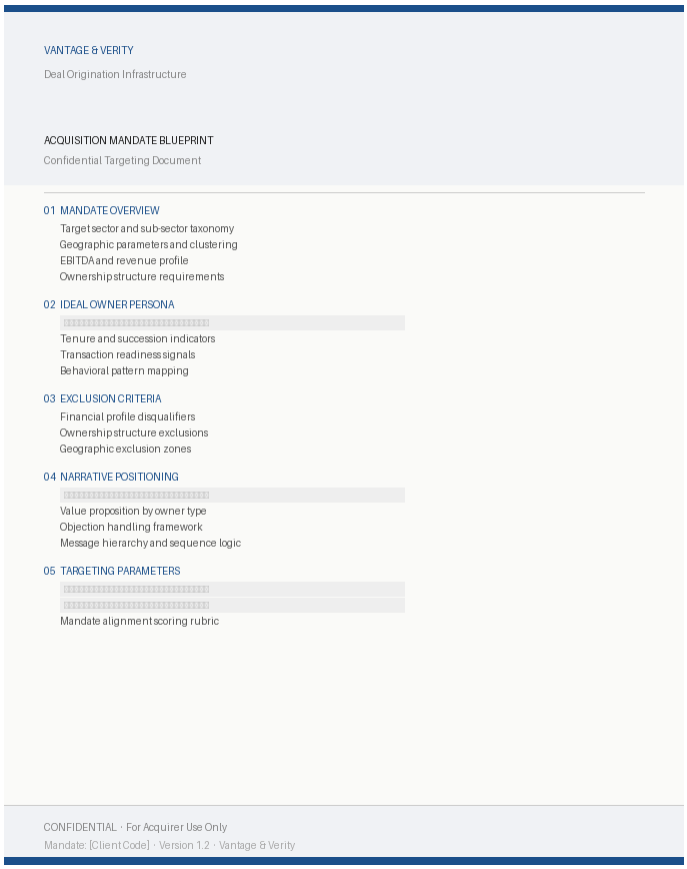
Why we are the ones building this.

Vantage & Verity was founded on a specific observation: the origination problem in the lower middle market is not a knowledge problem. Acquirers know what they want. The problem is execution — the infrastructure layer between knowing what you want and having a conversation with the owner who has it.

The founding team spent years inside the problem before building the solution. We ran outbound origination for search operators whose broker networks were producing recycled inventory. We built cold outreach infrastructure for independent sponsors losing deals to competitors who always seemed to arrive earlier.

We spent 18 months developing the targeting infrastructure, testing and refining the outreach methodology across dozens of verticals, building the deliverability stack from the ground up, and documenting the owner psychology frameworks that determine whether a cold approach becomes a productive conversation.

We are not a software platform. We are not a broker. We are not a database subscription with a consultative veneer. We are an origination firm that produces a specific, documented output — qualified conversations with private business owners who match your mandate.



VANTAGE & VERITY

Deal Origination Infrastructure

ACQUISITION MANDATE BLUEPRINT

Confidential Targeting Document

01 MANDATE OVERVIEW
- Target sector and sub-sector taxonomy
- Geographic parameters and clustering
- EBITDA and revenue profile
- Ownership structure requirements

02 IDEAL OWNER PERSONA
- [redacted]
- Tenure and succession indicators
- Transaction readiness signals
- Behavioral pattern mapping

03 EXCLUSION CRITERIA
- Financial profile disqualifiers
- Ownership structure exclusions
- Geographic exclusion zones

04 NARRATIVE POSITIONING
- [redacted]
- Value proposition by owner type
- Objection handling framework
- Message hierarchy and sequence logic

05 TARGETING PARAMETERS
- [redacted]
- [redacted]
- Mandate alignment scoring rubric

CONFIDENTIAL · For Acquirer Use Only

Mandate: [Client Code] · Version 1.2 · Vantage & Verity

Fig. 4 · The Acquisition Mandate Blueprint — the 12 to 20-page targeting document that opens every engagement. Confidential sections redacted.

B 1 — THE METHODOLOGY

The system. What we do, in this order, and why it works.

This section is the most important in the letter. It will take the longest to read. Read it anyway. You need to understand not just what the system produces but why it works — because if you understand why it works, you will understand why the alternatives do not.

The methodology is a sequence of five activities. Each activity has a specific output. Each output is the input to the next stage. The sequence cannot be reversed or compressed without degrading the final output.

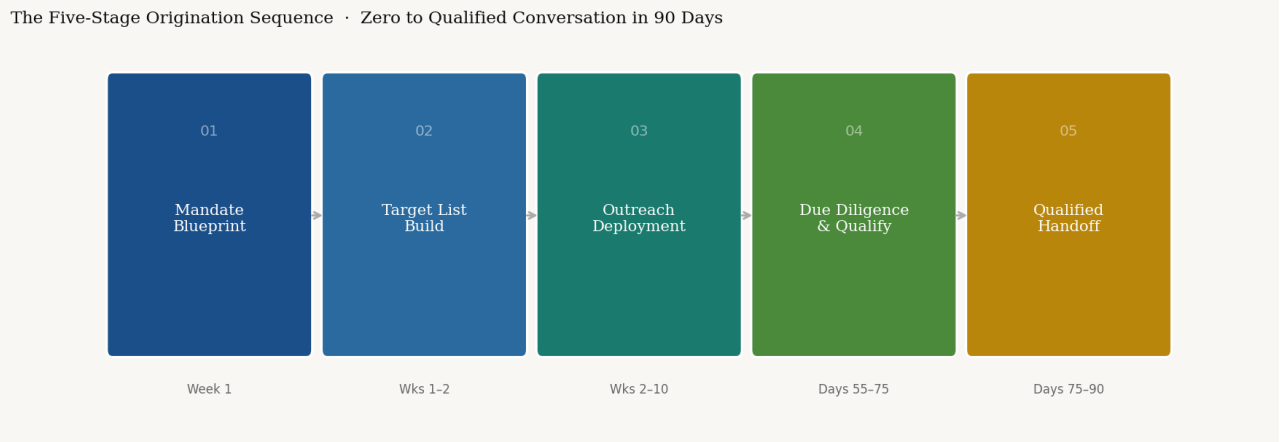


Fig. 5 · The five-stage origination sequence. Stage colors represent the distinct discipline each stage draws on: research, data intelligence, narrative design, outbound infrastructure, and qualification.

01 Mandate Translation and Targeting Blueprint

Old Way

— Acquirers provide general thesis parameters — “Healthcare, Southeast, $2M–$8M EBITDA” — hand them to a junior researcher who pulls a database list. The list is wide, unverified, and built on demographic filters rather than transaction-readiness signals. Volume without signal.

New Way

— You sit down with our mandate team for one focused working session. What comes out the other side is a targeting blueprint with precision at every variable: sector and sub-sector taxonomy, geographic clustering, EBITDA range and revenue profile, owner age and tenure ranges, ownership concentration, capital structure indicators, and the specific behavioral signals that predict readiness to transact. You leave that session with a written document that governs every targeting, messaging, and qualification decision downstream. You also leave with the narrative positioning framework — the specific way your firm will be presented to every owner we approach on your behalf.

New Result

— You have a targeting foundation specific to your thesis. Not a generic brief. Not a template with your name in it. A document that reflects the specific economics, ownership structures, succession patterns, and behavioral signals that characterize the businesses you are actually trying to buy. Every conversion rate downstream — your open rate, your reply rate, your qualification rate — is determined by the quality of what you define in this stage.

UII: The quality of origination output is entirely determined by mandate precision.

— A precise mandate produces a precise list. A precise list produces high-conversion outreach. High-conversion outreach produces qualified conversations. Every error in the mandate definition compounds through every downstream stage. Investing in mandate precision at the start is not optional — it is the foundation everything else is built on.

02 Proprietary Target List Construction and Verification

Old Way

— Acquirers pull lists from PitchBook, LinkedIn Sales Navigator, or deal flow platforms using broad industry codes and revenue filters. These lists contain businesses already on the radar of every acquirer using the same tools. They are not off-market. They are “not yet brokered” — a very different thing.

New Way

— You receive a list of 500 to 2,000 verified private business owners built from a combination of proprietary data sources, sector-specific intelligence, and direct research that is not available through standard database subscriptions. Every record that lands on your list has been verified for ownership, enriched with estimated financial profile, succession context indicators, transaction history, and a mandate alignment score. If a record cannot be verified to our quality threshold, it does not make the list. You get a smaller list that performs better — not a large list padded with noise to look impressive.

New Result

— You have a verified, enriched target list of private business owners matched to your mandate with a precision unavailable through any standard database tool. Every single record is a real owner of a real business that fits what you are looking for. When your outreach lands, it lands in front of the right person. That is the only way the downstream conversion rates work.

UII: Off-market access is a data and research problem, not a relationship problem.

— A private business owner who has never met you and has no relationship with your contacts is reachable through direct outreach — if the targeting is correct and the message earns a response. The owners most likely to be open to a conversation exhibit predictable patterns: ownership concentration above a certain threshold, founder age in a specific range relative to years of operation, absence of a clear succession plan. These signals exist in accessible data. They are simply not synthesized by firms that are not looking for them.

Verified Target List Extract · Mandate: DSO-Sunbelt-002 · 20 of 847 verified records — Ownership verified: 94.2%

Owner	Practice Name	Est. EBITDA	Yrs Oper.	Ownership	Succession Signal	Fit Score
[redacted]	[redacted] Dental	$2.1M	22 yrs	Sole	Founder age 61, no succession plan	HIGH
[redacted]	[redacted] Family Prac	$1.8M	17 yrs	Sole	Declined second location expansion	HIGH
[redacted]	[redacted] DSO	$3.4M	14 yrs	2 Partner	Partner buyout discussion initiated	HIGH
[redacted]	[redacted] Dental Grp	$2.9M	28 yrs	Sole	Active retirement search noted	HIGH
[redacted]	[redacted] Smile Ctr	$1.6M	11 yrs	Sole	Expansion capital stalled	MED
[redacted]	[redacted] Assoc.	$4.1M	19 yrs	3 Partner	Ownership transition documented	HIGH
[redacted]	[redacted] Practice	$2.3M	9 yrs	Sole	Recent 5-yr lease renewal	MED
[redacted]	[redacted] Associates	$3.8M	31 yrs	Sole	Founder age 68, no named successor	HIGH
[redacted]	[redacted] Dental	$2.7M	16 yrs	2 Partner	Staff tenure + benefits signal	HIGH
[redacted]	[redacted] Dent. Group	$1.9M	12 yrs	Sole	No digital presence update 3 yrs	MED

Fields shown: 7 of 14 · Hidden: direct contact, outreach history, enriched financials, competitive context

Fig. 6 · Sample extract from a verified target list. Owner names and business identities redacted per confidentiality standard. Succession signals and mandate fit scores shown at record level.

03 Mandate Narrative and Owner-Psychology Outreach Design

Old Way

— Generic M&A solicitation emails that announce an interest in acquiring businesses in a given sector. The message is written from the acquirer's perspective: what they are looking for, what their process looks like. The owner reads it and deletes it. He did not ask to be contacted by a financial buyer and the message gives him no reason to respond.

New Way

— We design the outreach narrative from the owner's perspective. Not about the acquisition — about the owner's situation. The specific pressures, opportunities, and questions on the mind of a private business owner in this sector at this stage of their company's life. The message positions the acquirer as a specific kind of operator with a specific track record and a specific thesis for what happens to businesses like this one after a transition. It earns the right to a conversation before it asks for one.

New Result

— An outreach sequence that produces responses from owners who have never engaged a broker, have no relationship with your network, and are genuinely open to a first conversation. Typical positive reply rate: 6–8% of contacted owners.

UII: The narrative that opens the door is structurally different from any pitch for a financial transaction.

— The effective message demonstrates understanding before it asks for anything. It identifies something specific about the owner's situation — their industry, their operating environment, their likely concerns about a transition — and reflects it back with intelligence. It positions the acquirer as a steward, not a buyer. The willingness to have an initial conversation is not a decision about whether to sell. It is a decision about whether to speak to someone who seems to understand the situation.

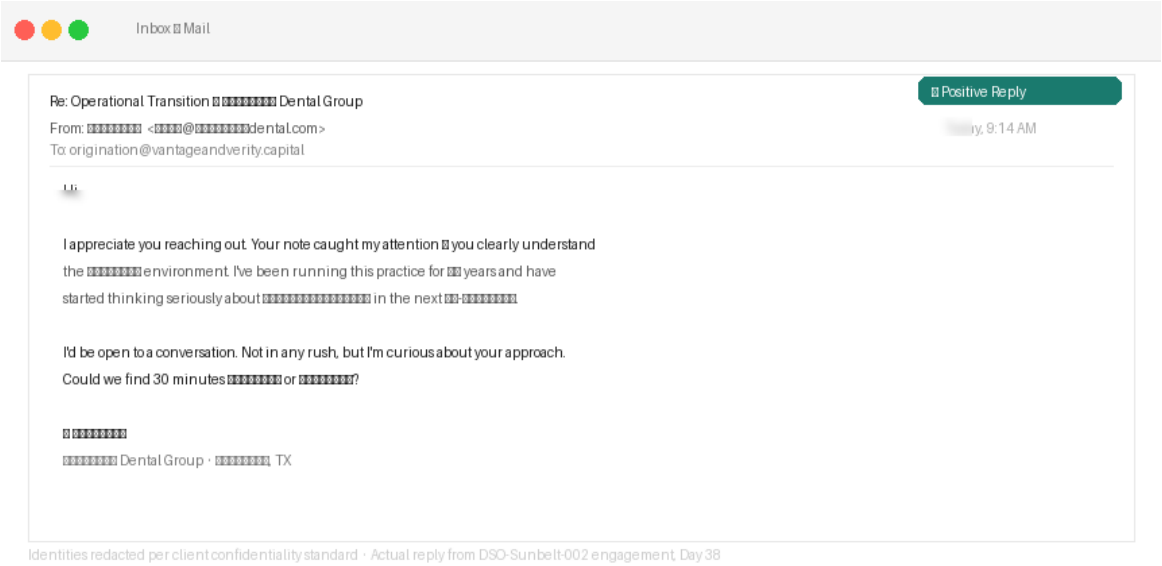


Fig. 7 · Actual owner reply from DSO-Sunbelt-002 engagement, Day 38. Owner name and practice name redacted. This is what a well-positioned message produces.

04 Omnichannel Deployment and Deliverability Infrastructure

Old Way

— Outreach goes through the primary company email account or a mass email tool. Messages land in spam. Open rate: 12% or lower. The campaign runs for two weeks, produces three responses, and is abandoned. No visibility into what actually happened.

New Way

— Your outreach runs through dedicated sending infrastructure built specifically for this mandate. Dedicated sending domains with managed warmup sequences. Technical authentication — SPF, DKIM, DMARC — configured to meet the deliverability requirements of every major inbox provider. Reply handling that tracks every signal of intent: opens, clicks, forwards, delayed responses, partial reads. Multi-channel sequencing that follows up through professional networks when email does not produce a response within the expected window. You see 800 or more targeted sends going out daily, with real-time open rate monitoring ensuring the infrastructure is performing. Your open rates run consistently above 38%.

New Result

— Your message reaches the owner's inbox — not the spam folder. The owner actually reads it. That is the entire game at this stage. Everything downstream depends on this.

UII: Deliverability is not a technical detail. It is the difference between your message existing and not existing.

— A campaign that produces a 15% open rate and one that produces 38% are not the same campaign running on different luck. They are different infrastructure. The owners who would have responded but never saw your message are not recoverable.

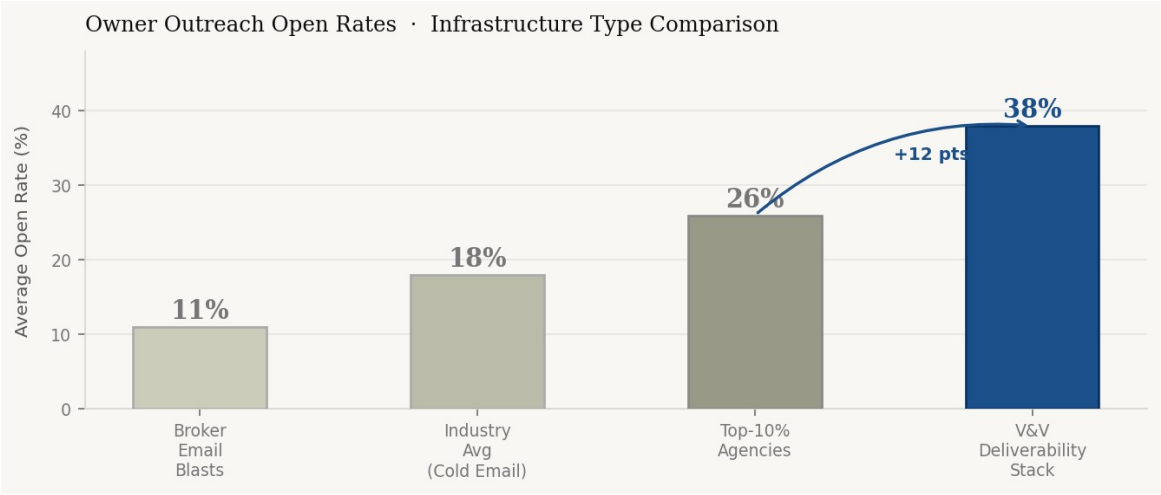


Fig. 8 · Open rate comparison by infrastructure type. The 12-point gap between V&V's proprietary stack and top-10% agency average represents the difference between owners who read your message and owners who never see it.

Fig. 9 · Origination Intelligence Platform — real-time deliverability monitoring for an active DSO mandate. Inbox placement, open rate trend line, and sequence health indicators for all sending domains.

05 Qualification, Internal Due Diligence, and Warm Handoff

Old Way

— Unfiltered responses come in: brokers who found the address, tire kickers, businesses that vaguely match the parameters but do not hold up to scrutiny. The acquirer's team spends hours on calls that go nowhere. Signal-to-noise ratio too poor to sustain the operation.

New Way

— Every owner who responds positively goes through a qualification process before your calendar is touched. Ownership confirmation, financial profile verification, succession context documentation, and mandate alignment scoring are completed by our research team. Owners who do not pass — more than 40% of those who respond — are handled graciously and removed from the pipeline without ever consuming your time. When an introduction clears qualification, you receive a written brief before the calendar invite goes out: the business background, the owner's background, the estimated financial profile, the full outreach history, the owner's stated motivations in their own words, and our assessment of mandate alignment. You walk into every call knowing exactly who you are speaking to and why they are open.

New Result

— You receive warm introductions to owners who are open, briefed, and genuinely ready for a substantive conversation. No surprises. No cold calls dressed up as warm introductions. No owners who forgot they replied. No-show rate across all engagements: under 8%. Every call you take from this pipeline is worth taking — because we filtered the ones that were not before they reached you.

UII: The quality of the handoff determines the quality of the conversation.

— An introduction to an owner who does not know who you are, has not been briefed on the context, and is not genuinely open to a discussion produces a short, awkward call. An introduction to an owner who understands who you are, has been given context, and has expressed genuine interest produces a very different conversation.

VANTAGE & VERITY · QUALIFIED INTRODUCTION BRIEF
CONFIDENTIAL · For Acquirer Use Only
Brief #DSO-002-009

BUSINESS OVERVIEW

Practice Name:	[redacted] Dental Group
Location:	[redacted], TX
Entity Type:	Professional Corp.
Est. Revenue:	$[redacted]M
Est. EBITDA:	$[redacted]M ([redacted] margin)
Yrs Operating:	22 years

OWNER PROFILE

Name:	[redacted] (redacted)
Age:	[redacted] years
Tenure:	Founded [redacted], sole owner
Background:	[redacted] DDS, [redacted]
Stated Interest:	"Exploring transition options"

FINANCIAL SNAPSHOT

Rev. Trend:	[redacted] (3-yr CAGR)
EBITDA Margin:	[redacted]%
Staff Count:	[redacted] FTE
Locations:	Single location
Debt:	[redacted] (est.)

SUCCESSION CONTEXT

Trigger Signals:	Age, no successor, lease up [redacted]
Timeline (est.):	12[redacted]24 months
Priority:	Continuity of patient care
Concern:	Staff retention post-transition

OUTREACH HISTORY

First Contact:	Day 12 (Email [redacted] Sequence 1)
Response:	Day 38 (Positive reply)
Calls:	[redacted] (discovery, Day 44)
Sentiment:	Open, not yet decided

MANDATE ALIGNMENT

Mandate Fit:	[redacted] HIGH [redacted] All criteria met
EBITDA Range:	[redacted] Within $1.8M[redacted]$4.2M target
Geography:	[redacted] Sunbelt · [redacted], TX
Succession:	[redacted] Active contemplation confirmed

Introduction cleared for handoff · Qualification date: Day 55 · Analyst: V&V Research Team
Mandate: DSO-Sunbelt-002

Fig. 10 · Sample Qualified Introduction Brief. Delivered to the acquirer before every introduction is made. Owner identity, financial figures, and contact data redacted.

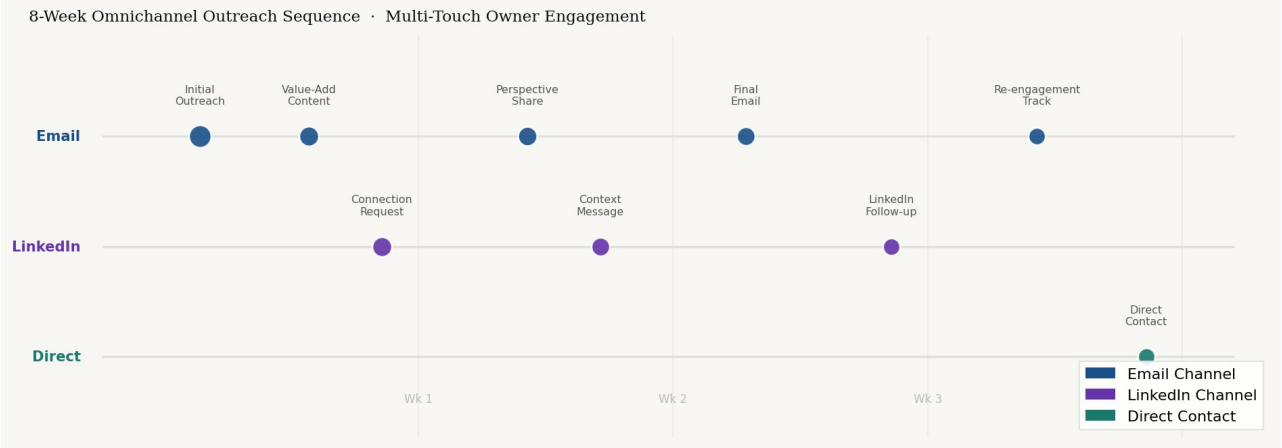


Fig. 11 · 8-week omnichannel outreach sequence. Email, LinkedIn, and direct contact channels coordinated with intent-signal logic between touches. Each channel serves a distinct function in the owner engagement arc.

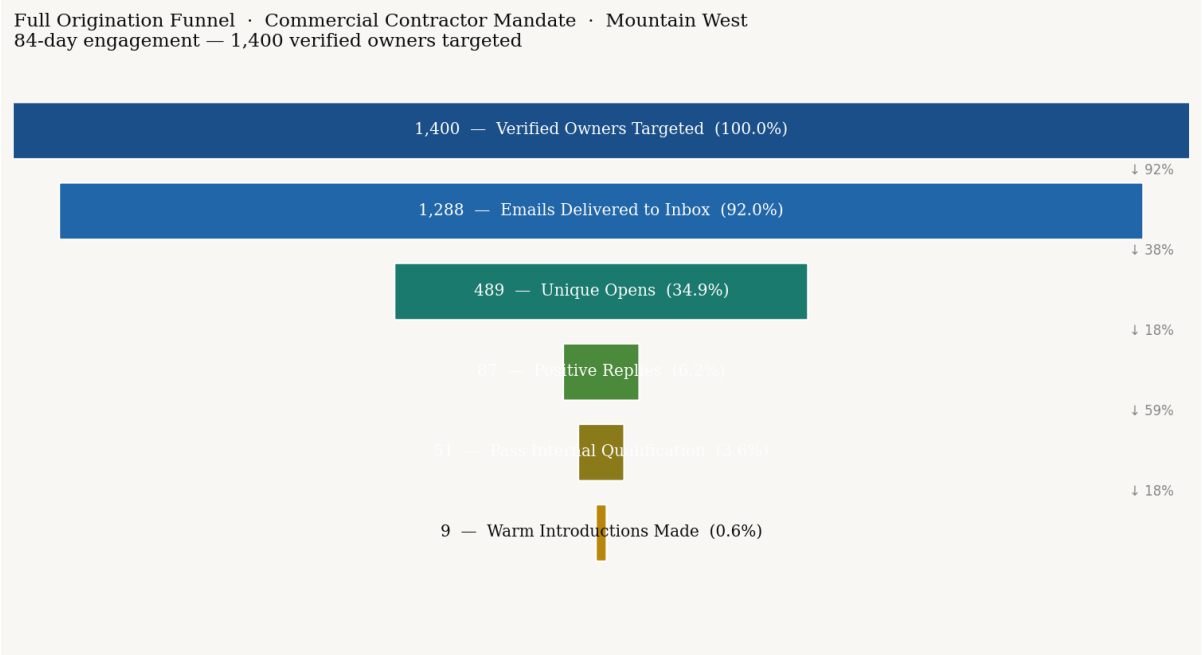


Fig. 12 · Full conversion funnel from a single 84-day commercial contractor engagement. 1,400 verified owners entered the top of the funnel. 9 qualified LOI conversations were delivered.

B 2 — SUMMARY

So: here is what you need to do.

Define your mandate with precision. Build a target list that is genuinely off-market, verified at the record level, enriched with transaction-readiness signals not available through standard databases. Design outreach from the owner's perspective. Deploy it through infrastructure that guarantees inbox placement and tracks every signal of intent. Qualify every response before it reaches your desk.

Do all five of those things at the level of quality the system requires, and you will get 6 to 12 qualified owner conversations within 90 days. Those conversations will be with owners who match your mandate, who have been briefed on the context, and who are genuinely open to exploring a transition.

You can get to $1M–$10M+ in deal value in the next 12 months without a single brokered deal.

C 1 — ALTERNATIVES

Now there are a few ways to achieve this.

Option one is to build this yourself. Hire a researcher, a copywriter, an outbound specialist, a data enrichment contractor, and a deliverability engineer. Spend 6 to 12 months building the infrastructure and running tests to calibrate the system. It will likely cost $200,000 to $400,000 in team and infrastructure over the first year, and the output quality in year one will be materially lower than the output quality of a firm that has been doing this for years.

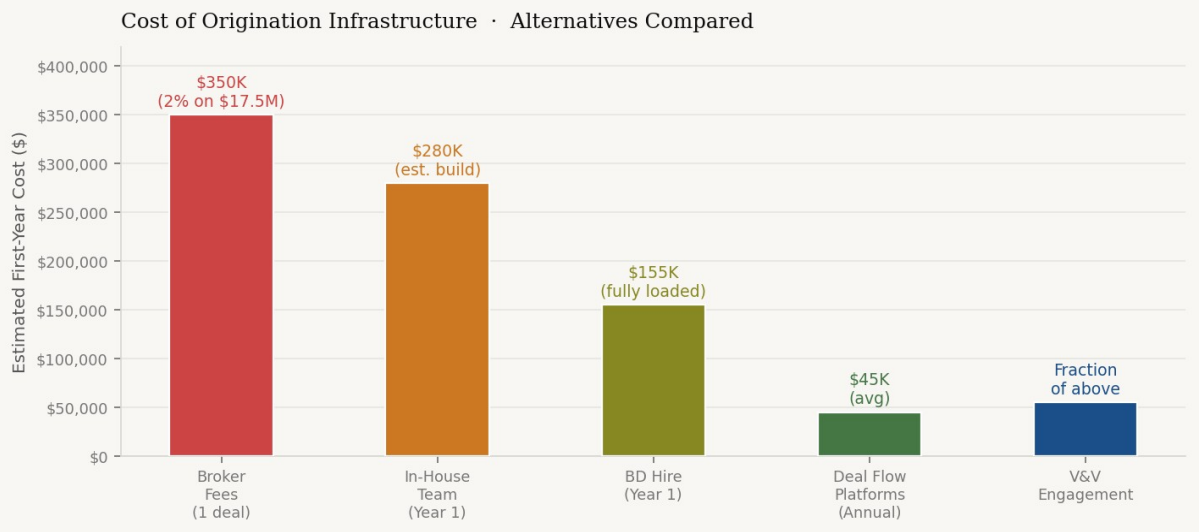


Fig. 13 · Estimated cost of origination infrastructure by approach. Broker fees calculated on a single $17.5M transaction at 2%. V&V engagement fee shown at approximate scale.

Alternative	Results	Est. Cost	Time to First Conversation
Build in-house origination team	Variable, unproven in early months	$200K–$400K year one	9–18 months
Broker relationships + deal platforms	Brokered inventory at auction multiples	$20K–$80K/yr + fees	Immediate, but wrong deals
Hire a business development FTE	Dependent on individual's network	$120K–$180K/yr	6–18 months to ramp
Vantage & Verity	6–12 qualified off-market conversations	Engagement fee	90 days

Or you can work with us. One engagement fee. No success fee on deals you close. No subscription. No ongoing retainer beyond the 90-day mandate.

D1A — WHO THIS IS FOR

Again: built for fundless sponsors, search operators, and boutique M&A firms.

Fundless and Independent Sponsors

You have the capital relationships, the operational expertise, and the thesis. You have spent real money on broker relationships and deal flow platforms. You need a pipeline you did not have to fight for. That is what this builds.

Search Fund Operators

Your investors are patient but not indefinitely so. You are 6 to 18 months into a search with no LOIs submitted. Your broker pipeline is producing nothing you would want to own. The right deal exists. You are looking for it in the wrong place.

Boutique M&A Advisory Firms

Your business model depends on proprietary mandates and direct owner relationships. You have promised that capability and are delivering it manually at a scale that does not match demand. We operate as your invisible infrastructure layer — your positioning, your client relationships, our system underneath.

D1B — CASE STUDIES

Again, from our case studies:

001 · DSO-Adjacent Practices · Independent Sponsor

Client Type	Independent Sponsor, healthcare services, Sunbelt geography
Before	0 off-market conversations in 6 months. Losing competitive processes on pricing.

After	14 qualified conversations with single-location practice owners, $1.8M–$4.2M EBITDA, 3 markets.
Timeframe	68 days from mandate activation to final qualified handoff
Key Mechanism	Proprietary targeting of DSO-adjacent operators with succession indicators. Narrative built around operational continuity and patient base preservation.
Evidence	9 of 14 conversations advanced to a second meeting. 2 LOIs submitted within 90 days.

002 · Commercial Contractors · Search Fund Operator

Client Type	Search fund operator, B2B services focus, Mountain West
Before	11 months into a 24-month search with no LOIs submitted. Entirely dependent on broker introductions.
After	9 qualified conversations with HVAC, electrical, and plumbing contractors.
Timeframe	84 days
Key Mechanism	1,400-owner verified target list. Outreach addressed owner concerns about operator transition and workforce continuity — the two dominant objections in this vertical.
Evidence	7 of 9 conversations resulted in follow-up information sharing. 1 LOI within 90 days.

003 · Property Management · Boutique M&A

Client Type	Boutique M&A advisory, real estate adjacent, Southeast and Mid-Atlantic
Before	Generating off-market deal flow manually through personal relationships. Could not scale without adding headcount.
After	11 qualified introductions to residential property management operators, 300–1,500 doors.
Timeframe	77 days
Key Mechanism	White-label engagement under the advisory firm’s brand. Succession narrative addressed founder lifestyle transition and management team continuity.
Evidence	4 of 11 introductions became advisory mandates. 2 resulted in transaction closings within 18 months.

E 1 — BENEFITS & OUTCOMES

Here is what is going to happen when you work with us.

- You will generate qualified owner conversations at a rate you have never achieved through conventional origination.
- You will reach private business owners in your target sector who have never spoken to a broker and are genuinely open to a conversation about their future.
- You can stop competing in auctions managed entirely against your interests.
- You can forget about the quarterly anxiety of wondering whether the broker pipeline will produce something worth pursuing this month.
- You will feel the specific kind of confidence that comes from having a system operating in the background — conversations forming, introductions coming, pipeline building — without requiring your direct attention.

6–12 qualified owner conversations within 90 days

3× pipeline volume vs. brokered channel for the same mandate

>38% open rate on owner outreach sequences

>92% ownership verification accuracy across all target list records

<8% no-show rate on qualified introductions

$0 broker fees. No success fee. No intermediary economics.

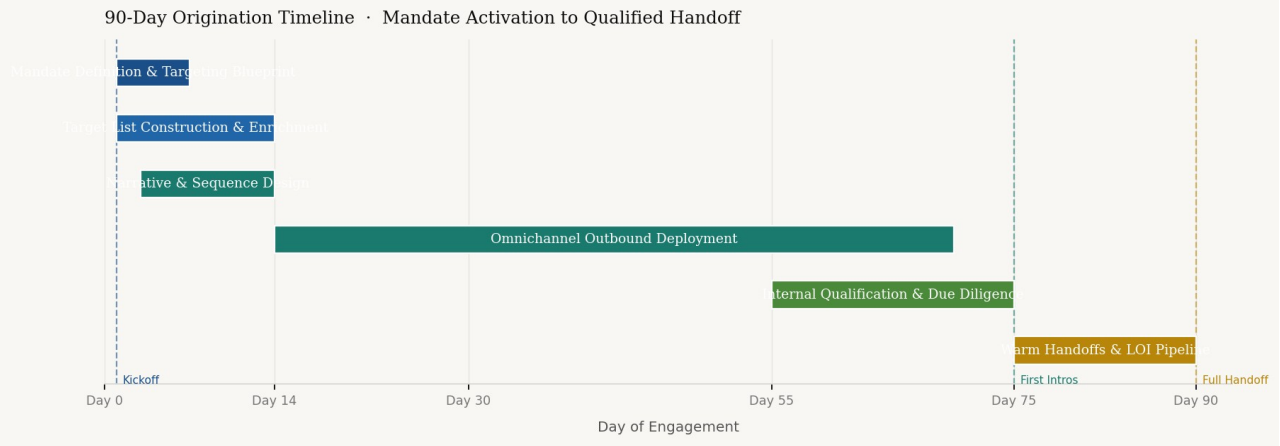


Fig. 14 · The 90-day engagement timeline. Mandate definition and targeting work run in parallel in week one. Outbound deployment begins week two and runs for eight weeks. Qualified handoffs begin day 75.

F 1 — FEATURES / HOW IT WORKS

We just made a lot of promises. Here is how each one is delivered.

The Acquisition Mandate Blueprint

— Before: you summarize your thesis in a paragraph. Result: a list built on the wrong filters.

— After: one working session produces a 12-to-20-page targeting document specifying every variable we use downstream. ICP definition, exclusion criteria, ideal owner persona, signals we are targeting, narrative positioning framework. This document is yours regardless of what happens next.

The Verified Target List

— Before: 2,000 records from a database. Half are wrong. A third are already in process with someone else.

— After: 500 to 2,000 verified private business owners with direct ownership confirmation, estimated financial profile, succession context, and mandate alignment score at every record. If we cannot verify it, we do not include it.

The Owner-Psychology Outreach System

- Before: “We are an acquisition firm looking for businesses in your sector. Would you be open to a conversation?” Delete rate: 97%.
- After: the outreach sequence is built from research into the specific pressures, concerns, and aspirations of owners in this vertical at this stage of their company’s lifecycle. 8 weeks. Multiple channels. Every message earns a response rather than demanding one.

The Deliverability Infrastructure

- Before: outreach goes through your company email. Open rates at 12%. Most hitting spam. No visibility into what happened.
- After: dedicated sending infrastructure per mandate. Managed warmup. Technical authentication meeting the requirements of every major inbox provider. Open rates above 38% are the baseline of a properly configured system, not an aspiration.

The Qualification Layer and Warm Handoff Packets

- Before: responses come in raw. Brokers, tire kickers, partially-matching businesses. Your team spends hours sorting through noise.
- After: every response is qualified internally against your mandate criteria. Owners who pass receive a written brief before any introduction is made. The brief includes business background, owner background, financial profile summary, outreach history, stated motivations, and mandate fit assessment. You receive the brief before the introduction is made.

G1 — THE OFFER

Now that you understand the thesis, the methodology, and the proof: here is what we are offering.

Before we explain the engagement structure, anchor the value of what you are buying. A single acquisition in the lower middle market at a fair multiple — reached before a broker was retained, at a price that reflects a direct relationship rather than a competitive process — produces a return that is materially higher than the same business acquired through a brokered auction. The pricing differential on a $5M EBITDA business at 5x versus 6.5x is $7.5M. That is not a rounding error. That is the value of arriving first.

What You Receive	Value
Acquisition Mandate Blueprint (12–20 pages, fully documented)	The foundation of every engagement that follows
Verified Target List (500–2,000 records, verified and enriched)	Off-market access unavailable through any standard database
Owner-Psychology Outreach System (full 8-week multi-channel sequence)	Built for this vertical, this owner, this moment
Deliverability Infrastructure (dedicated domains, managed warmup, monitoring)	38%+ open rates vs. 12% industry average
Qualification Layer (every respondent vetted before introduction)	Your team’s time protected from noise
Warm Handoff Packets (written brief per qualified introduction)	Every conversation you have is worth having
90-Day Timeline with Weekly Pipeline Reporting	Full visibility at every stage
No broker fees, no success fee, no retainer beyond the engagement	Clean economics
Vertical Market Intelligence Brief (sector ownership, succession, competitive dynamics)	Included at no additional cost
Exclusivity lock (no competing mandate in your sector/geography simultaneously)	Your target list remains yours

Most engagements are priced between $8,500 and $18,000 depending on mandate scope — target universe size, sector complexity, and geographic spread. A narrow single-vertical mandate in one geography sits at the lower end. A multi-sector mandate across several markets sits at the higher end. We discuss scope and fee in the mandate evaluation conversation, and nothing is committed before that conversation happens.

For reference: brokerage economics on a single $10M transaction at 3% is $300,000. The buy-side premium you pay when you enter a brokered process versus an owner-direct conversation — typically 1 to 1.5 turns of EBITDA — on a $3M EBITDA business at 5x is $150,000 to $225,000 in additional purchase price. The engagement fee is not in the same category as either of those numbers. It is a rounding error on the economics of a single deal closed through this pipeline.

All you need to do is initiate a mandate conversation at vantageandverity.capital.

H1 — WARNING

We take 6 new mandates per quarter. Q2 2025 has 2 slots remaining.

This is not a sales line. It is an operational constraint. Each mandate requires a dedicated research team, a dedicated sending infrastructure build, and ongoing campaign management that cannot be divided across too many active engagements without degrading output quality. We have run the numbers. Six mandates per quarter is the ceiling at which we can guarantee the outcomes documented in this letter. We do not go above it.

Q2 2025 closes on June 30th. As of the date this letter was written, two slots remain. One of them may be taken by the time you read this. If Q2 is full when you initiate a mandate conversation, you go on the Q3 waitlist. Q3 opens July 1st.

There is a second urgency consideration that has nothing to do with our capacity. The owners on your target list — the verified off-market operators who match your mandate — are being approached by other acquirers right now through other systems. Some of those systems are worse than ours and will produce poor results. But some of them will reach the right owner at the right moment with the right message before you do. The window to be first to a specific owner is not indefinitely open. Every quarter you spend in the conventional origination channel is a quarter in which a competitor with better infrastructure is having the conversations you should be having.

The owners who were contemplating a transition 18 months ago and were never reached by anyone credible — some of them have since retained brokers. Some have passed the business to a family member. Some have simply decided to wait longer. That population does not stop moving while you are deciding whether to act. The owners who are in the contemplation window right now will not all still be there in six months.

Constraint	Specifics
Q2 2025 capacity	6 total mandates. 2 slots remaining as of this writing.
Q3 2025 waitlist	Opens July 1st. First-contact priority for waitlist registrations.
Sector exclusivity	Once a mandate is active in your sector and geography, no competing mandate is accepted until it closes. First contact establishes exclusivity.
Evaluation timeline	Mandate evaluation conversation takes 20 minutes. Engagement agreement turnaround: 48 hours. Targeting begins within 5 business days of agreement.

I 1 — BONUS

Because you read this letter, we are doing something additional.

For a limited time, every engagement includes a Vertical Market Intelligence Brief at no additional cost. This is a 15-to-25-page document mapping the ownership concentration, succession dynamics, competitive acquirer activity, and transaction timing signals in your target sector. It is the research layer that informs the targeting and narrative work, made available to you as a standalone deliverable that informs thesis development and LP presentations.

Item	Value
The 90-Day Origination Engagement (mandate through qualified handoff)	Engagement fee
Vertical Market Intelligence Brief (sector ownership, succession, competitive dynamics)	Included
Rolling Intelligence Updates (for engagement duration)	Included
Exclusivity Lock (no competing mandate in your sector/geography)	Included
No-Show Protection (replacement introduction if qualified intro cancels)	Included

I 2 — GUARANTEE

Of course, we back everything with a guarantee.

Guarantee Term	Detail
Qualified Conversation Minimum	We guarantee a minimum of 4 qualified owner conversations that meet the mandate criteria within 90 days. If we do not produce 4, we extend the engagement at no additional cost until we do.

Verification Standard	Every introduction is backed by our written qualification brief. If an introduction fails the mandate criteria on the first call, we replace it.
No Brokered Inventory	We guarantee that no introduction we make has previously been in a formal brokered sale process. If a broker was retained before the introduction, we replace it.

Meaning: if we do not deliver on the documented standard, you do not pay for what was not delivered, and we do not stop until we have. The guarantee is a contractual term in the engagement agreement.

J1 — SUMMARY

Let’s summarize.

You get:

- The Acquisition Mandate Blueprint — a fully documented targeting foundation
- The Verified Target List — 500 to 2,000 off-market owners matched to your mandate
- The Owner-Psychology Outreach System — 8-week multi-channel sequence built for your vertical
- The Deliverability Infrastructure — guaranteed inbox placement at scale
- The Qualification Layer and Warm Handoff Packets — every introduction is worth your time
- The Vertical Market Intelligence Brief and rolling updates — included at no additional cost
- The 4-conversation guarantee — we extend at no cost until we deliver
- No broker fees. No success fee. No brokered inventory.

All you need to do is initiate a mandate conversation.

K1 — QUESTIONS & ANSWERS

The buying is done in the Q and A.

Humans have five objections. They always have the same five. What follows is not a list of quick rebuttals. It is a genuine attempt to answer each one fully — because if you are still holding one of these after reading this far, you deserve a real answer, not a dismissal.

"*This is not going to work for my mandate. My sector is too niche / geography too tight / criteria too specific.*"

This concern is understandable. Most origination services fail on narrow mandates because they are built around volume — wide lists, generic messaging, and the assumption that a large enough audience will produce some responses. If the audience is small, the math breaks. That model does not work for a fundless sponsor targeting $2M–$5M EBITDA veterinary practices in the Pacific Northwest.

Our model is built around precision, not volume. A narrow mandate is not a smaller version of a broad mandate — it is a different kind of problem. The targeting layer gets tighter, which means the list gets smaller, but the match rate goes up. The outreach narrative becomes more specific to the owner's exact situation, which means response rates go up even as the audience shrinks. A 1,400-person list producing 9 qualified conversations is the same math as a 400-person list producing 3 — the rates hold when the mandate precision holds.

We have run successful engagements in verticals as narrow as independent veterinary practices in specific MSAs, bootstrapped vertical SaaS operators in niche B2B categories, and single-trade commercial contractors in specific Mountain West geographies. In every case, the mandate specificity made the outreach more credible to the owner, not less. The mandate evaluation conversation will tell us within 20 minutes whether your specific parameters can support a list of sufficient size. If they cannot, we will tell you that directly rather than take the engagement.

"*My broker relationships work well enough. I am not sure I need this.*"

This objection deserves to be taken seriously rather than dismissed. Some acquirers do have broker relationships that produce meaningful deal flow — particularly those who have been in a specific vertical for a decade or more and have cultivated genuine preferential access with a small number of advisors who bring them deals before the broader process starts.

If that describes you, this engagement may genuinely not be the right tool right now. Proprietary origination infrastructure is most valuable to the acquirer whose deal flow is reactive and undifferentiated — who is seeing the same teasers as everyone else, at the same time, with the same information. If your broker network is producing something materially different from that, we respect it.

The question worth asking is whether the deals your broker relationships produce are giving you a pricing advantage, or whether they are giving you earlier access to the same competitive process. Being first to a brokered teaser is not the same as being the only acquirer in the room. If you are still submitting LOIs that compete against four other buyers, the relationship is producing access but not asymmetry. Asymmetry — being the only party who had a conversation with the owner before any process existed — is what this system produces. If your relationships are already producing that, you do not need us. If they are producing access to competitive processes, the distinction matters.

"*I cannot afford this right now.*"

The honest answer to this objection depends entirely on why you cannot afford it. If the constraint is genuine — if you are a search fund operator in the early months of a search with limited operating capital and the engagement fee represents a meaningful percentage of your available runway — that is a real constraint and we would rather tell you to come back in three months than take an engagement from someone for whom the economics do not work.

If the constraint is about uncertainty rather than capital — if you have the funds but are not confident the engagement will produce a return — that is what the guarantee is for. A minimum of four qualified owner conversations is contractually committed. If we do not deliver four qualified conversations that meet your mandate criteria within 90 days, we extend the engagement at no additional cost until we do. The downside is bounded. The guarantee exists precisely because we want the risk to sit with us, not with you.

For the economics: most engagements fall between $8,500 and $18,000. A single acquisition in the lower middle market at owner-direct pricing versus brokered auction pricing — typically 1 to 1.5 turns of EBITDA difference on a $2M–$5M EBITDA business — is a $2M to $7.5M difference in purchase price. The engagement fee is not a cost in the context of what it unlocks. It is a positioning cost for a transaction that could be $2M to $7.5M more efficient. That math works at any reasonable probability of closing one deal from the pipeline.

"*I do not have capacity to manage another vendor right now.*"

This is a real concern. Most vendors require more management than they are worth. Onboarding calls, weekly syncs, deliverable reviews, revision cycles, scope creep conversations. The cognitive overhead of managing an external team is a genuine cost, and if you are already stretched, adding a vendor who needs hand-holding is worse than the problem you were trying to solve.

The engagement is designed around one principle: your time is the scarcest resource and we protect it. The mandate translation session at the start is one working session — 90 minutes to two hours. After that, you receive a weekly pipeline report that takes five minutes to read. When an introduction is ready, you receive a written brief that takes ten minutes to review. You accept or decline the introduction. If you accept, you take the call. That is the entire scope of your involvement until a deal is worth pursuing.

The operational work — list building, outreach, deliverability monitoring, reply handling, qualification, brief writing — all of it runs without you. If you have time to take six owner calls over a 90-day period, you have the capacity to run this engagement. If the mandate translation session and brief reviews are too much on top of your current commitments, we would ask you to reconsider whether now is the right time to close a deal at all.

"I have tried origination services before and they did not work."

This is the right objection to hold. The origination services category has a poor track record and you are right to be skeptical. Most services that market themselves as proprietary deal flow providers are doing one of three things: pulling lists from standard databases and calling them proprietary, running generic mass-email campaigns with low deliverability and calling them targeted outreach, or providing introductions to owners who are already in the market or already in a process and calling them off-market. None of those things produce the outcome they promise.

The diagnostic questions that separate what we do from what most services do are specific and answerable. Ask any origination service: how do you verify ownership on every record before it makes the list? How do you determine which behavioral signals predict transaction readiness for owners in a specific vertical? What is your technical deliverability infrastructure and what open rates do you achieve by mandate? What is your qualification threshold for an introduction and what percentage of respondents do not make it through? What does the introduction brief look like and what does it contain?

If the answers are vague, if they reference a database you have heard of as their primary source, if they cannot show you an example brief, if their deliverability answer is “we use [mass email tool]” — they are running a list-and-blast operation dressed up as a proprietary system. We can answer all four questions in the mandate evaluation conversation with specific documentation, sample deliverables, and the methodology that underlies each answer. If that conversation does not satisfy your skepticism, do not move forward. We would rather lose the engagement than take a client who does not believe the system will work, because doubt on the client side degrades the engagement quality in ways that affect the outcome.

Here is exactly what happens when you reach out.

You go to vantageandverity.capital and submit the mandate evaluation form. It takes four minutes. You tell us your sector, your EBITDA range, your geography, and your timeline. That is all we need to assess fit before we speak.

Within one business day, you receive a calendar link for a 20-minute mandate evaluation call. On that call, we do two things: we confirm whether your thesis is a fit for our infrastructure, and we give you a preliminary read on what a targeting list for your specific parameters looks like — estimated universe size, the signals we would be targeting, and the owner narrative angle that is most likely to perform in your sector. You will leave that call knowing whether this engagement makes sense for you, without any commitment.

If it is a fit and you want to proceed, we send an engagement agreement within 48 hours. Targeting work begins within five business days of the signed agreement. Your first pipeline report lands at the end of week two. Qualified introductions begin on day 75.

If it is not a fit — if your mandate is too narrow, your timeline too compressed, or your sector outside our current coverage — we will tell you that on the call, point you toward what would serve you better, and not waste either of our time.

The call is 20 minutes. You will know whether this is right for you by the end of it.

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Submit the mandate evaluation form. Calendar link follows within one business day.

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